PENNSYLVANIA · HOME CARE AGENCY LICENSE

Pennsylvania Home Care License Readiness Checklist

Everything the Pennsylvania Department of Health will expect to find in place before it licenses a non-medical home care agency under 28 Pa. Code Chapter 611 — in one page, so you can tick it off before you apply and before any inspection. From AutoloomStudio, the makers of the Pennsylvania policy and procedure manual.

Before you apply — and before any inspection

- [ ] Physical office at the application address, open during stated business hours; a conspicuous place chosen for the licence; business registration and fictitious name certificate in the licence file
- [ ] Current copy of 28 Pa. Code Chapter 611 at the office (§611.4(a)); Chapter 51 and the Act available
- [ ] Governing Body resolution adopting the manual and appointing the Administrator; organisational chart; job descriptions signed; Password Agreement signed
- [ ] Nondiscrimination policy adopted, dated, posted; staff notification signed; publicity planned
- [ ] Owners' criminal history reports on file and available (§611.52(a), (f)); ChildLine verifications if serving minors, or the adults-only attestation
- [ ] Administrator's and office staff's criminal history reports (within the past year) and TB documentation where there will be direct consumer contact
- [ ] At least one complete direct care worker file : interview date, two satisfactory references, criminal history report with request form and residency declaration, competency documentation, TB screening dated within one year, job description, acknowledgment, orientation
- [ ] Competency examination with answer key, and the training programme curriculum covering all sixteen §611.55 subject areas, on file
- [ ] Consumer information packet assembled; the service agreement reviewed for the 10-day and 14-day arrears terms
- [ ] Consumer record system ready; home folder set; complaint, incident and Department-notification forms ready
- [ ] Calendar started: licence expiry and 60-day renewal date; TB and competency due dates; publicity due date
- [ ] Emergency preparedness plan completed; infection control supplies on hand; home safety assessment form ready
- [ ] Insurance in place and disclosed correctly (liability — maintains / does not maintain; workers' compensation)
- [ ] Marketing and website describe the Agency only as a licensed home care agency providing non-medical services and claim no licence before it issues

Key contacts (verify at the time of use)

- Pennsylvania Department of Health, Division of Home Health — Home Care Agencies and Registries page: www.pa.gov/agencies/health/facilities/out-patient-healthcare-facilities/home-care (regulations, FAQ, forms, portal links); licensure questions ra-dhhlicenquestions@pa.gov; online application and change-of-ownership portal sais.health.pa.gov (Initial Provider Application — DHH); portal process questions RA-dhhomehealth@pa.gov; login help RA-DHHLoginHelp@PA.gov; agency changes (address, counties, administrator) by letter to ra-dhhliceonlychange@pa.gov; changes of ownership ra-dhhchows@pa.gov; exception requests ra-dhhomehealth@pa.gov; FAQ-era mailing address: Division of Home Health, 2525 N. 7th Street, Harrisburg, PA 17110
- Department of Health complaint Hot Line (for the consumer packet): 1-866-826-3644
- Licence look-up (find a licensed home care agency; monthly licence exports): sais.health.pa.gov/commonpoc/dohQALocatorcommon.asp; apps.health.pa.gov/DHHLicense/
- Rules: 28 Pa. Code Chapter 611 and Chapter 51 at pacodeandbulletin.gov (the Department also posts PDFs on its Home Care Regulations page); Health Care Facilities Act, 35 P.S. §§448.101 et seq.; 6 Pa. Code Chapter 15 (Older Adults Protective Services Act regulations)
- Criminal history reports: Pennsylvania State Police ePATCH, epatch.pa.gov (purpose "Employment"); FBI fingerprint route and Department of Aging letter of determination — Pennsylvania Department of Aging [current fingerprinting vendor and instructions on the Department of Aging's website — verify]
- ChildLine child abuse history clearance (only if serving persons under 18): Department of Human Services Child Welfare Portal, compass.state.pa.us/cwis
- Office of Long-Term Living (Medicaid waiver enrolment after licensure): 1-800-932-0939 option 1; RA-HCBSEnProv@pa.gov
- Patient Safety Authority (linked from the Department's home care page): patientsafety.pa.gov

Ready to apply? Here is the next step.

44 policies | 50 forms | Editable Word + PDF

Every line on this checklist has a written policy and a form behind it in the Pennsylvania Home Care Agency Policy and Procedure Manual — Non-Medical Home Care Edition. Written to the text of 28 Pa. Code Chapter 611 with every policy cited and the rule's own words in each one, a crosswalk from every requirement to the page that meets it, the application guide, and a "what to watch" layer for the points the rule leaves open.

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This checklist is drawn from the published text of 28 Pa. Code Chapter 611 and the regulator's published application materials as of October 2026. It is a template, not legal advice, and it is not approved or endorsed by the Pennsylvania Department of Health. Rules, forms and fees change — check the regulator's page before you rely on any item. © 2026 AutoloomStudio. You may print and use this checklist for your own agency; please do not resell it.